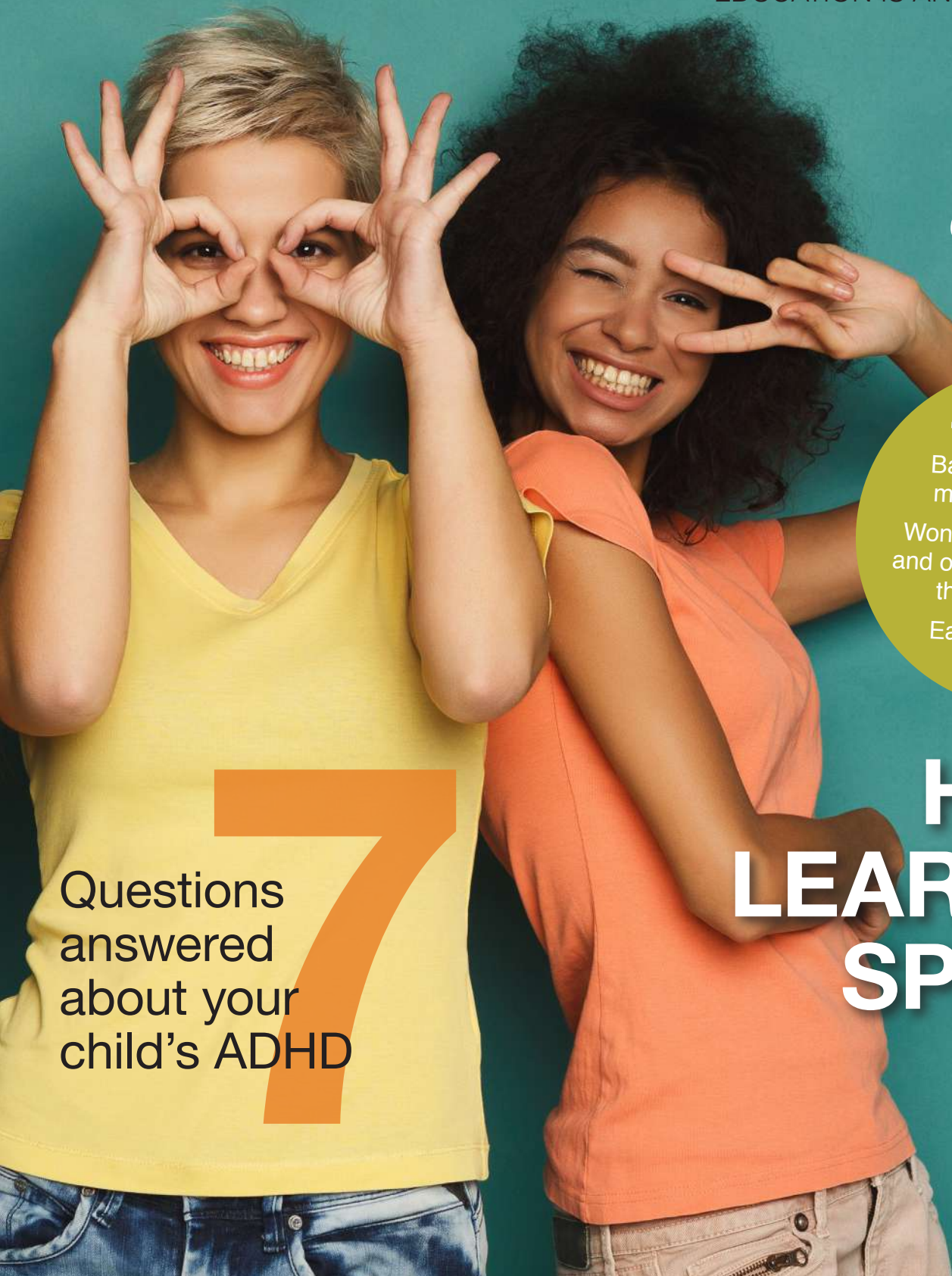


Two young women are smiling and making hand gestures over their eyes. The woman on the left is wearing a yellow shirt and the woman on the right is wearing an orange shirt. They are both making 'OK' hand gestures.

sa

ISSUE 9, 2022

Homeschooling

EDUCATION IS AN ADVENTURE

*Healing
effects
of music
therapy*

+PLUS:

Balancing life as a
mom and teacher

Wonderful local events
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Easter crafts and
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Questions
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7

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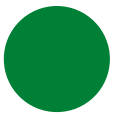


Virtual Clubs



Active Home Education Institute

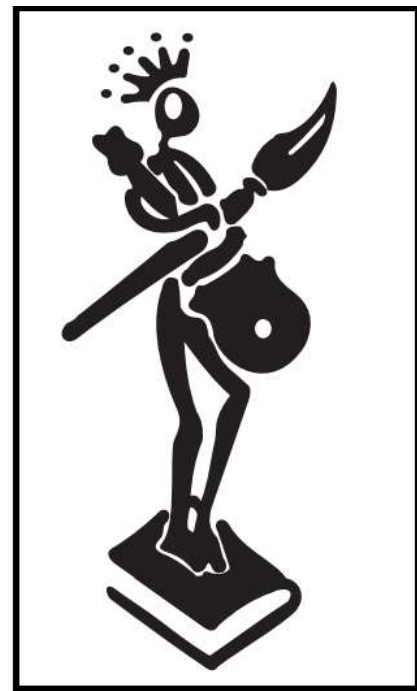
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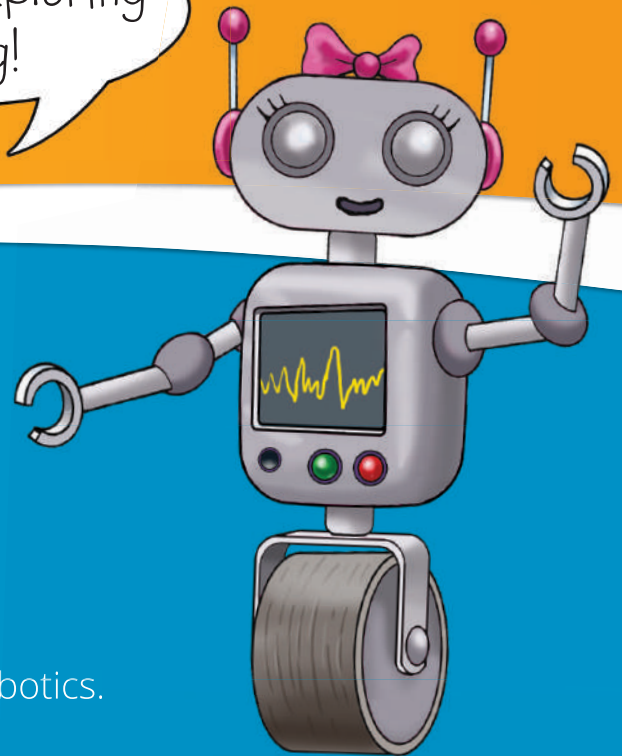
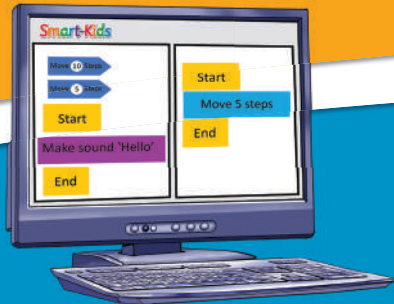
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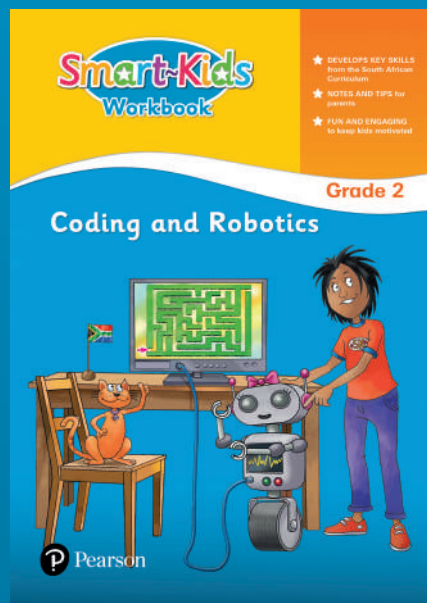
Have fun exploring coding!



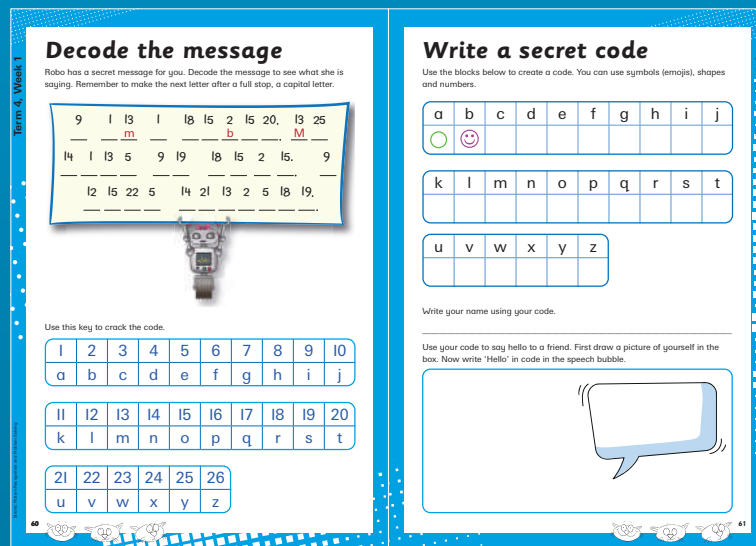
Meet Robo!

Robo is the new Smart-Kids character who will help teach children the basic principles of coding and robotics.

Aligned to the draft coding and robotics curriculum released by the Department of Basic Education, the Smart-Kids Coding & Robotics Workbook for Grade 2 consists of write-in worksheets that can be used by teachers to introduce the subject to young learners, or by parents who want their child to learn and practise the skills required for coding and robotics.

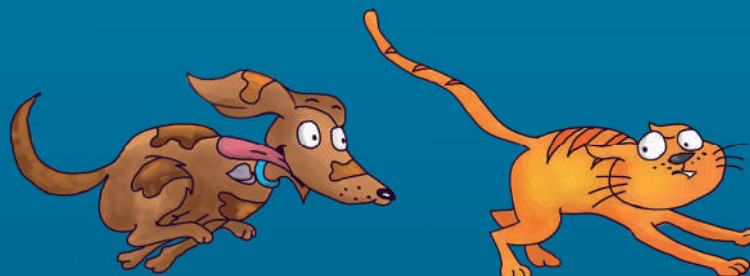


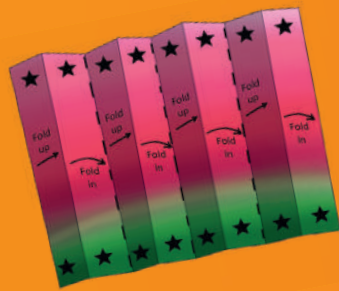
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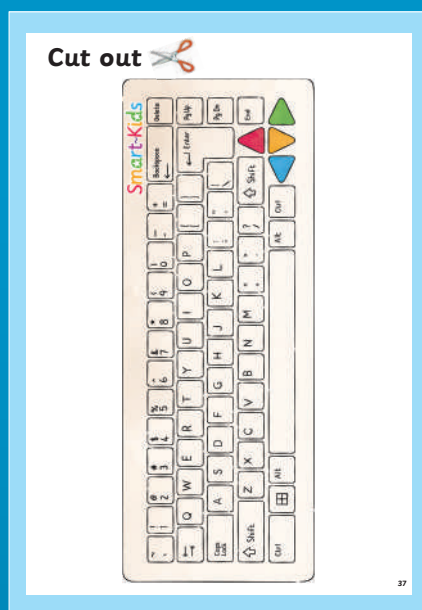
Available from all leading bookstores and online retailers.

A Teacher's Guide is also available as an eBook at shop.pearson.com

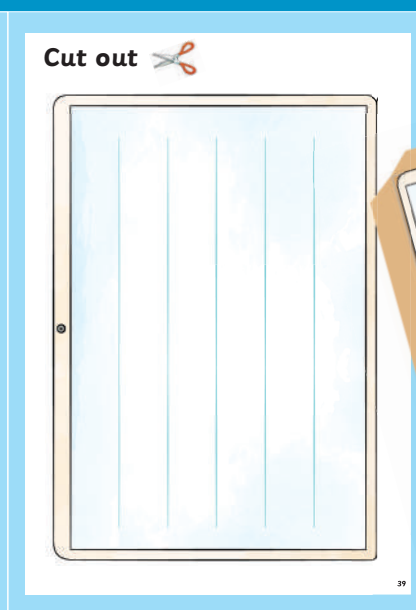




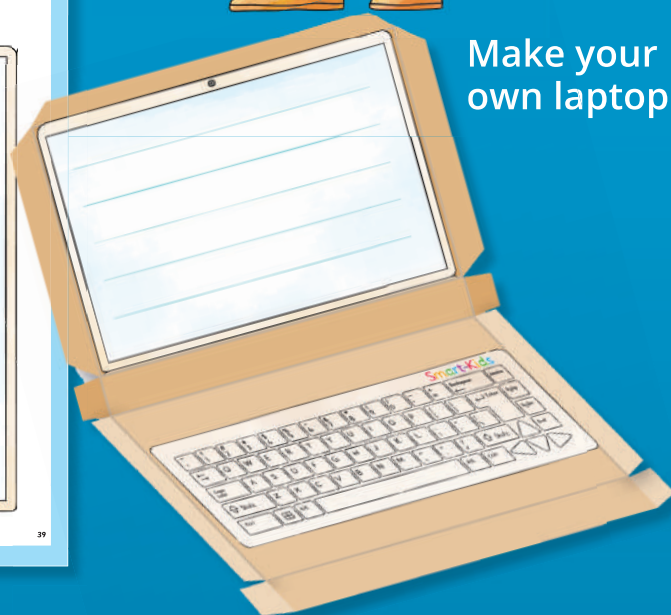
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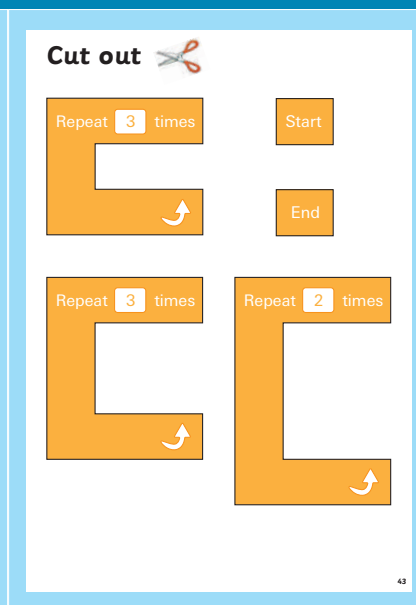
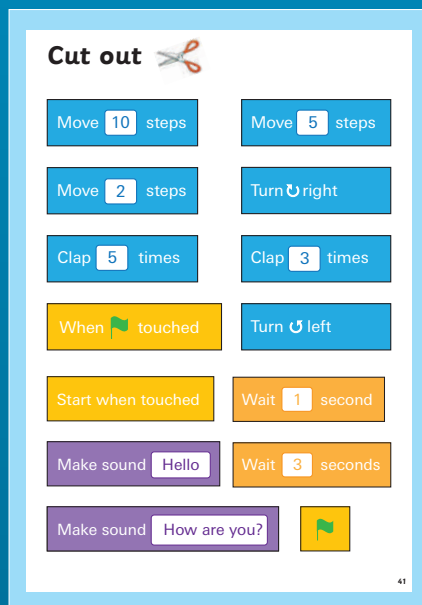
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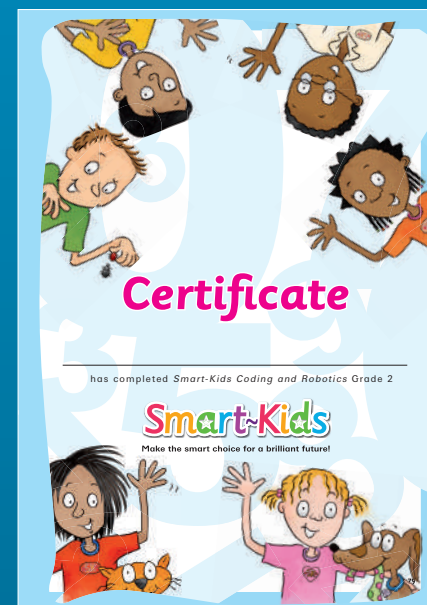
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CHAT TO US!

Your **feedback is essential** in helping us put together a magazine which delivers on-point content relevant to your homeschooling experiences and support needs and **helps you navigate** your child/children's education with ease and confidence.

You are the **core** of the publication, so let's live and learn together.

Email our editor, Adri Viviers,
at: adri@isikhova.co.za.



sa Homeschooling
EDUCATION IS AN ADVENTURE

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Many parents I talk to who're considering homeschooling are primarily concerned about whether they have the knowledge and skills to teach their children. They're worried about not having any training as a teacher, when – in fact – they've already had years of such training, *because that's what parenting is.*

The moment your child is born, you become their first and most influential teacher. From day one, your child looks to you for so much in life. They use your actions as a guide to make sense of the world around them and develop the skills to take them further in life as they grow up.

Without realising it, you've already taught your children a great many things, both academic and non-academic.

You're also the one who knows your child better than any teacher in a formal school environment ever could. You know their personality, what motivates them, what they're capable of, their interests, their strengths, their fears and their challenges.

When you homeschool, self-doubt may arise every so often, but rather than fall victim to such thoughts, remember that even for certified

teachers, some days are harder than others. Be kind and patient to your kids – and yourself.

And remember that you're not alone on this journey, as there are many resources and avenues for help at your disposal, including this magazine. The homeschooling community is an extremely welcoming and supportive one and you'll find many other parents who can share information with you, compare experiences and collaborate with you from time to time.

Above all, remember that research indicates that no amount of formal teaching can compare with the influence which you, as a parent, have on your child, whom you already teach every day – by word and example.

Happy reading!

Adri

Education is an adventure

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A host of factors go into deciding which learning path best fits our children. Homeschooling is a great choice for many families. There are disadvantages, along with (many) advantages to homeschooling. In this article, we focus on the advantages

More and more families are starting to realise the numerous benefits associated with homeschooling. Here are our top ones:

1 Child-led learning This is probably the main reason home education is so different from school. We all learn more effectively when we study things that interest us. Children come to love learning because they're able to explore the topics that intrigue them, in addition to a syllabus.

2 They can learn at their own pace and progress faster Children experience a lot of frustration when forced to work at an unnatural pace. When a particular subject is easy for a child, they can move on, rather than be bored by repetitive reviews and extra pages of practice. This means they can take more time to get to grips with the subjects that challenge them.

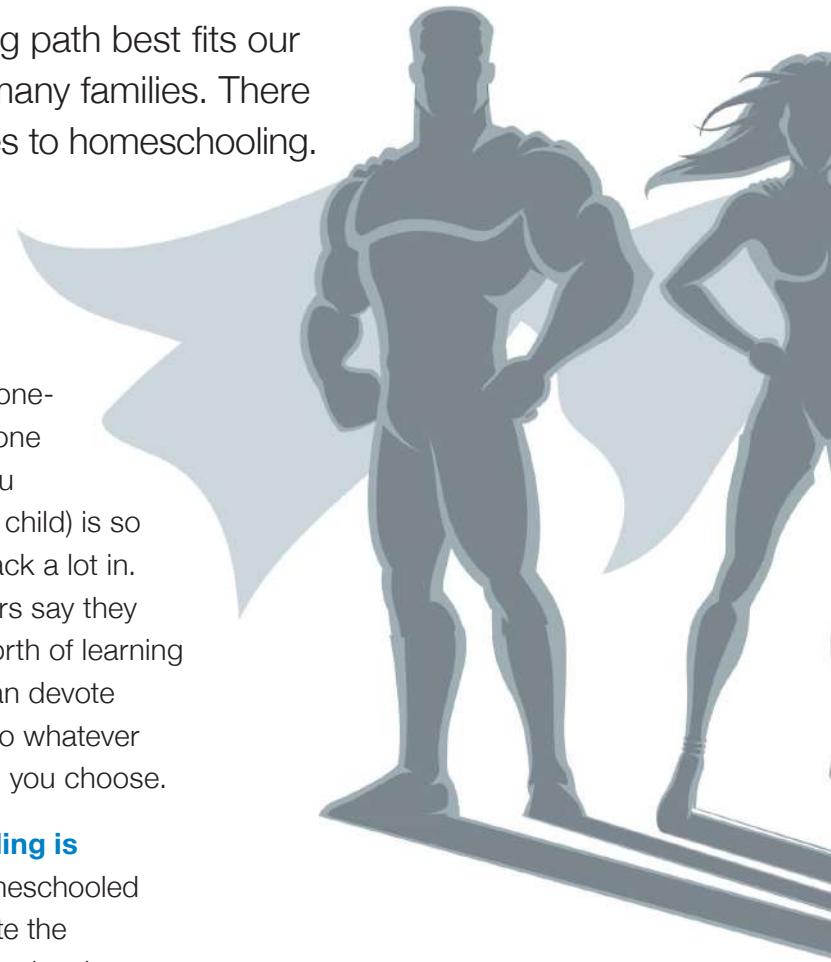


3 Benefits of one-to-one teaching Because one-to-one teaching (or one to two or three, if you have more than one child) is so effective, you can pack a lot in. Some homeschoolers say they complete a day's worth of learning in two hours. You can devote the rest of the time to whatever subjects or activities you choose.

4 Homeschooling is efficient Homeschooled children can complete the same amount of schoolwork as

children in an institutionalised school in much less time. This is because they waste less time on transportation and waiting in line. It's also because children who love learning tend to stay on task and work more efficiently.

5 A flexible schedule make life easier for the whole family No rushing out of the house in the mornings and having to meet all sorts of sched-



The benefits of hom



ules, not to mention meetings and other commitments. Children who receive homeschooling can enjoy breaks with their parents during the year. There are also many opportunities for excursions, museum/gallery visits and parks. These can perfectly match what they're learning at home at the time.



homeschooling

6 It boosts confidence If your child really struggles with certain subjects (ie, if they have “uneven skills”, as one homeschooling parent put it), but excels at others, you can structure their learning accordingly, which helps boost their confidence.

7 Homeschoolers do better in tests One study of 20 000 homeschooling children in the USA revealed that they

definitely passed tests better. This was especially evident in children who'd homeschooled up to high school level. In another study, homeschoolers in the SAT test scored about 67 points more than the national average. In SA, a homeschooled Durban girl recently made news headlines when she achieved the highest marks in the world for accounting and biology in the Cambridge Assessment International Education examinations.

8 Children have more emotional freedom

Homeschooling removes the stress from the normal classroom. It isn't necessary for children to try to “fit in” and cope with peer pressure. There are no cases of bullying, drugs, eradication and all the other social pressures. In her book, *A Sense of Self: Listening to Homeschooling Adolescent Girls* (Heinemann), Susannah Sheffer describes finding that homeschooled teens don't lose self-esteem and are generally happier and more emotionally mature young adults.

9 Homeschooling allows for children's special needs

If a child has special needs, they can be bullied or labelled in the school system. This can be a hindrance and is often a social stigma. ADHD children often suffer all kinds of prejudices and obstacles. If the child is sensitively taught at home, their special needs are never forgotten



and they're always the most important priority. (Read our story on ADHD on page 20.)

10 Children can be more independent

When homeschooled students at university were interviewed, they described being much more independent in their approach to life and learning. They never felt the need to follow the crowd and this served them well. In solving learning problems, they were much more independent in finding solutions themselves.

11 Homeschooling promotes family unity

Learning and working together draws families closer. Homeschooling gives them the chance to have more quality time together.



More than just a song

Music has been used for centuries to promote mental and physical health in children and adults. It's one of the few mediums that stimulates the whole brain (and the whole soul) at once

What exactly is music therapy and how does it work?

Music therapy is when music and sound are used in different forms to improve a person's physical, emotional, social and mental health. The American Music Therapy Association defines it as "the clinical and evidence-based use of music interventions to accomplish individualised goals within a therapeutic relationship by a credentialed professional".

In the musical therapeutic process, a safe space is provided within which a child can express their feelings without the use of words. Of course, there's room for talking too, but putting feelings into words isn't always easy for everyone. With music therapy, the music does the talking and the

musical process provides valuable information to the therapist regarding a child's emotions and inner experience.

The key to successful music therapy, with a licensed professional, is being able to understand the influence music has on the mind and body. Music can help people relate to and understand their emotions, as well as identify, control and gain awareness of them.

Individuals don't require formal musical ability. In fact, musicality and rhythm are innate to all human beings, starting in the womb. Music therapy is a process of making, being affected by and responding to music to address specific individual goals.

"You know the feeling you get when you hear one of your favourite songs? Your mood lifts, your body relaxes and you easily recall happy memories."



As every child is unique, forms of music therapy are different for each individual. Possibilities include:

- **Physical:** Music therapy can improve fine and gross motor skills, balance, mobility and co-ordination of movement
- **Social:** Music therapy can develop verbal and non-verbal communication, self-expression and promote social interaction and group cohesion.
- **Mental:** Music therapy can promote sensory integration, increase attention span and facilitate the learning of academic concepts.
- **Emotional/Spiritual:** Music therapy can increase emotional expression, promote behavioural skills and improve self-confidence.

A growing body of research and evidence proves the effectiveness of music therapy with children and young people. Once a child's particular needs and goals are identified, a music therapist creates a specific plan to address them.

Music therapy in its active form involves the child doing something with the music (eg dancing, singing, tapping or clapping), or as a receptive form, where the child is receiving music through listening. All methods can include verbal processing of feelings and experiences, if the child's old enough to do so.

The uses of music can be divided into four modes:

Is it OK for kids to listen to music while studying?

Music stimulates positive emotions while studying, but can be a distraction.

Australian-based researcher Bill Thompson aimed to figure out the relative effect of these two competing factors – mood and distraction.

He had participants do a fairly demanding comprehension task and listen to classical music that was either slow or fast, soft or loud. He found the only time there was any real decrease in performance was when people were listening to

music that was both fast and loud. However, the decrease in their performance wasn't significantly big.

So, can kids listen to music while studying? Research suggests it's probably fine – with some caveats. It's better if it's neither too loud nor too fast, nor too wordy.

- *For a fascinating insight into the tremendous healing power of music in adults, read Musicophilia: Tales of Music and the Brain by British neurologist Oliver Sacks (Pan Macmillan).*



1. Improvising.
2. Performing or recreating (when the child learns or performs pre-composed music).
3. Composing (the child can write songs, lyrics or instrumental pieces).
4. Listening (the child listens to music and responds accordingly).

Research further shows the benefits of music therapy in children and adolescents with:

- Behavioural disorders.
- Mood and anxiety disorders.
- Attention deficit/hyperactivity disorder (ADHD).
- Autism spectrum disorder (ASD).
- Trauma.
- Substance misuse disorders.

You know the feeling you get when you hear one of your favourite songs? Your mood lifts, your body relaxes and you easily recall happy memories. That's why music therapy for kids makes perfect sense.



Balancing life as a mom and teacher

A mother wears many hats and performs many different jobs. Caretaker. Provider. Encourager. Therapist. Chef. Chauffeur. Supporter. Doctor. And if you're homeschooling your child, you can add one more job to your resumé – teacher. *SAH* spoke to mom of three Jana McGhee about balancing being a wife, a mom and a homeschool parent

Jana is a qualified FET science and maths teacher, but last year she left her career as teacher at a public high school to homeschool her two sons and a daughter. She loves being a mom more than anything and says spending time with her kids cooking, gardening, reading and just being together is what she wants most.

Tell us about your kids. Ethan's nine and a busy, active boy with the ball sense I never had. He has sensory processing disorder, but you'd never guess it. Aiden's eight and a very sensitive child. He knows when Mama needs a cup of coffee and never shrugs off a hug or a kiss. He's very lovable, but can also be a prankster and he's always ready with a joke. Bella's four and keeps me on my toes. She has a very clear idea of what she likes and dislikes and has all of us wrapped around her little finger. She's very animated, fearless and doesn't step back for her brothers.

Why did you decide to homeschool? If Covid-19 showed me one thing, it was that our children need a different education from what the Department of Education and the traditional school system can offer.

Ethan had to spend time having therapy and we had an "at-home programme" that we just couldn't master in between "real school", activities, homework and me

yes you can!

working. Aiden also had some issues and we were concerned that these wouldn't be addressed well in a classroom with 25 other children. Bella simply never adapted well to school. She cried at every drop-off and it never improved.

We decided during the lockdown that I'd stay home from 2021 and try to be 100% present for them. About two months later, we made the decision to homeschool. We all finished our public school careers in December 2020.

What were you afraid of when you first started homeschooling? I feared "being behind" and still do. But when that fear pops up, I just ask myself: "Behind who?" We might be behind at the moment, but in three years' time, I believe we'll be ahead.

How has your homeschooling approach changed since you began? I never wanted to buy a box curriculum. One thing we were sure about was that we didn't want to do "school at home". We

wanted time, freedom and for the kids' studies to be interest-based. When we started, I had grand ideas – eclectic could sometimes mean erratic, as there were so many wonderful resources. I wanted to do too much and was overwhelmed. Fortunately, we didn't spend much money, whereas a friend of mine spent thousands of rands in the first year just finding the right curriculum fit. Now we focus on numeracy and literacy and "unschool" the rest.

What's homeschooling really like? It's what you make it, but I truly believe it shouldn't look like school at home. Homeschooling looks like late lie-ins, lots of squabbling, lots of laughter and doing something you never knew you could.

How do you balance being a wife, mother and homeschooling parent? Homeschooling should be a

lifestyle of learning, not a to-do list to tick off. It takes the pressure away. When we made the decision to homeschool, something in my heart and head changed, even though we were still in formal schooling for another six months. I made an effort answering the kids' questions: instead of just a short answer, I'd do a little research and share what I found with them. They often joke that we do "car schooling" – we do fractions and discuss time, science, storms and what plants need to grow.

What tips can you offer to avoid stressing out? I know that it's hard, especially for a former maths and physical science teacher (as well as a self-proclaimed academic snob!), to "let it go" – but who's chasing you? Always put relationships first. Also, make time for yourself.



What's your favourite homeschooling moment?

The feeling I get when they learn something and their excitement at understanding how something works, especially when they ask to do some bookwork or science. I also love it when they learn something they wouldn't have learnt at school yet (if ever). At those times, it all feels worthwhile.

What advice would you offer other wives and mothers looking for ways to wear multiple "hats"? They don't need to be different hats. Being a teacher is part of being a mom – did you have a qualification to teach them to walk, talk or love? Neither do you need a qualification to teach them to read and write. Teaching our children how to be kind, considerate and make healthy choices is no different from teaching them how to read and write. You can instill a love for reading and learning in them and when it comes to the difficult stuff, there are so many resources available that you only facilitate learning.



Find minutes for yourself

The 15-minute break

Sometime in the day, find 15 minutes of kid-free time. Some people like getting up before the kids, some staying up after they're in bed and others intentionally set a time in the middle of the day. Use this time to do something that will take a little longer and can give you a much-needed pause. Have a shower. (Maybe sing in it for extra fun!) Pray or meditate. Read a chapter of a book. Have a cup of your favourite warm drink. Lie down on the couch and power-nap. Tell the kids you're on break for 15 minutes and unless there's blood or the house is on fire, you must be left alone. (Bathroom doors with locks are a miracle some days!)

The 30-minute break If you have little ones, strap them into their stroller and, while they're contained – go for a walk. You can even put a podcast or audiobook onto a mobile device and listen while you walk! Do an exercise video.

Sit in the backyard and listen to the birds. Have a bubble bath. Talk to a friend. Watch a YouTube video of something you want to learn. Spend some time on your hobby.

The longer break Go out for coffee with a friend. Do a moms' or dads' night out. Join an adult class or study group. Go to the spa and get a manicure. If your kids are in a class or lesson, chat with other parents or curl up in the corner or car to read. After the kids are in bed, binge-watch a new or a favourite show. Go out to the movies or a play.

The getaway If leaving the kids at home and going away is the best way for you to fully recharge, go for it. Plan a weekend alone, with your spouse or friend. Go to a homeschool conference. Do a reverse getaway and send the kids to their grandparents' house for a night.

Acknowledgement: The Canadian Homeschooler.

COMING IN ISSUE 10

SA HOMESCHOOLING'S 2022 PHOTOGRAPHIC COMPETITION

SA Homeschooling is an adventure and part of it is getting creative, using your imagination and enjoying every minute of the experience.

And we're thrilled to bring you our latest adventure - our 2022 Photographic Competition.

This *SA Homeschooling* initiative is aimed at encouraging children to express themselves through photography, inspire creativity and encourage artistic skills.

The prize offerings are going to be FUNtastic and add even more excitement, fun and learning to your children's' homeschooling life!

Full entry details and rules will be published in our next issue (Issue 10).



Easy, delicious end-of-summer picnic food ideas

Anri Fourie shares four picnic recipes that are perfect for kids to help prepare. They're also very easy to pack up and take to the park, the beach – or simply enjoy in your garden or indoors for lunch

There's a lot to love about summer, but it always comes and goes too quickly. As this season draws to an end, bid it farewell with a final picnic to soak up the sun. These recipes are quick and easy to make and delicious to eat. So gather the kids in the kitchen, start cooking and pack up your picnic basket!

Heart-shaped sun-dried tomato and mozzarella pizzas

Preparation time: 20 mins

Cooking time: 15 mins

Ingredients:

1 sheet of puff pastry
(defrosted and kept in the fridge)
250ml (1 cup) grated mozzarella cheese
200g finely chopped sun-dried tomatoes (or cherry tomatoes)
1 tsp (5ml) fresh oregano
Balsamic glaze



What else will you need?

A rolling pin
A tablespoon
A teaspoon

A heart-shaped cookie-cutter (I often use my kids' clay-cutters for fun shapes)

A baking tray (well coated with cooking spray)

Method:

- Preheat oven to 180°C.
- Roll out the puff pastry using a rolling pin (dust the top of the puff pastry and surface with a little flour).
- Press out heart-shaped forms using the cookie-cutter.





Chicken and pineapple skewers with basil mayo dressing

Preparation time: 45 mins

Cooking time: 20 mins

Ingredients:

4 chicken breasts,
cut into 2-4cm cubes
1 tin pineapple pieces
2 red bell peppers
(seeded and cut into 3cm chunks)
1 red onion, cut into 3-4cm chunks
175ml (¾ cup) tomato sauce
75ml (¼ cup) soya sauce
5ml (1 tsp) fresh garlic
250ml (1 cup) mayonnaise
250ml (1 cup) basil leaves,
finely chopped
Purple onions, cut into rings
or large chunks

What else will you need?

6-8 wooden skewers
Two mixing bowls and spoons
A teaspoon
A small saucepan
An oven pan
Tin foil

Method:

- Preheat oven to 180°C.
- Make a marinade by mixing the syrup from the tinned



pineapple pieces with the tomato sauce, the soya sauce and the fresh garlic.

- Pour half the marinade over the cubed chicken breasts and allow to marinate for 20 minutes in the fridge.
- Pour remaining half of the marinade in a small saucepan and reduce until you have a thicker consistency of the sauce.

Anri Fourie, owner of two guesthouses and mom of an eight-year-old daughter and four-year-old triplets, cooks meals that are quick and easy to make – with multiple little helping

hands. In the Fourie household, family time is a great time to cook together. As the former owner of a coffee shop, Anri used to share the kitchen with skilled chefs. Today she shares it with her four busy little offspring, who're all eager to pitch in and help.



- Place heaped tablespoons of mozzarella cheese on each cookie and spread.
- Place heaped teaspoons of sun-dried tomatoes on each cookie and spread.
- Place the cookies on the baking tray and bake until golden-brown (approximately 15-17 mins).
- Top with roughly cut fresh oregano and drizzle with balsamic glaze.



- Thread the skewers by starting with a piece of the marinated chicken, then a pineapple cube, a bell pepper and a ring or chunk of purple onion. Repeat until all the skewers are fully threaded.
- Place the skewers on the oven pan (cover the oven pan with tin foil to prevent the sticky sauce from burning it).
- Bake for 15-20 minutes, turning and glazing with the sticky sauce every five minutes until the skewers are caramelised and glossy and the chicken is cooked through. (If you prefer, you can braai them instead of cooking them in the oven.)

For the dipping sauce:

Mix the mayonnaise with the finely chopped basil leaves and serve the sauce with the cooked skewers.



Blueberry pancake stack with honey

Preparation time: 15 mins

Cooking time: 20 mins

Ingredients:

1 x packet flapjack mix (you can make the batter from scratch, but this is quick and easy and there are many nice mixes available. I prefer the Woolworths one)

300g fresh blueberries

100ml honey

Sunflower oil for frying

What else will you need?

A mixing bowl

A large frying pan

A tablespoon

A spatula

Method:

- Make the flapjack mix according to the packet instructions.
- Add the blueberries to the flapjack mix.
- Cover the base of a large frying pan with oil and place it on a medium heat.
- Add 30ml (2T) of batter per flapjack and cook until bubbles form on the surface.
- Turn the flapjacks over and cook for another 2 minutes, or until nicely browned.
- Drizzle with honey before serving.

Homemade iced tea is easy to make and contains far less sugar than store-bought varieties. Make this refreshing, healthy iced rooibos tea using teabags or loose tea leaves and pack it into your picnic basket.

Boil water in a kettle or a pot and pour into a large jug. Add two teabags or 4-5T of tea leaves and allow to steep for five minutes. Remove the teabags or strain the tea to remove the tea leaves. Add lemon juice, along with the sweetener of your choice to taste (eg honey, agave syrup or sugar).

Allow the tea to cool down, then place it in the fridge. Leave it for a few hours or overnight to chill it completely.

Pour into a picnic water cooler to take on your picnic.



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7 questions answered about your child's ADHD

“The biggest consequence of ADHD is the labels many kids are given at home/in school/by family and friends and the effect those labels have on their self-esteem.”

When a parent suspects or has recently received an ADHD diagnosis, they usually have many questions. Dalena van der Westhuizen, cognitive development specialist, master brain coach and co-founder and Managing Director of BrainAbility, answers some of them

What's the difference between **ADD** and **ADHD**? In the past (and even now), people referred to attention struggles where there was no hyperactivity as attention deficit disorder (ADD). That terminology, however, has changed and we now only refer to attention deficit hyperactivity disorder (ADHD).

ADHD is the umbrella term used to describe children (and adults) who experience significant challenges with focus, impulsivity or hyperactivity.

Are there different types of ADHD?

There are three main types of ADHD, which differ according to the symptoms that present most commonly:

ADHD, predominantly inattentive: People with this type of ADHD don't exhibit signs of hyperactivity or impulsivity. Instead, they're easily distracted





and find it difficult to pay attention. (This is the one often referred to as ADD.)

ADHD, predominantly impulsive/hyperactive: This is the least common type. The person shows signs of hyperactivity and the need to move constantly, as well

as displaying impulsive behaviour. They don't show signs of becoming distracted or inattentive.

ADHD, combined presentation: This is the most common type of ADHD. The person shows impulsive and hyperactive behaviour, as well as being easily distracted and struggling to maintain attention.

Does this hamper a child's ability to learn and keep up with academic work? For most children with ADHD, processing of information can be slower. This might mean that it may take longer for all or some of the stages of learning to occur.

For me, the biggest consequence is the labels many kids are given at home/in school/by family and friends and the effect those labels have on their self-esteem – they're

often labelled as lazy, naughty or trouble-makers.

What are the treatment options for ADHD? Medication. Cognitive behavioural therapy. Cognitive development programmes (aimed at strengthening weak underlying skills for attention and focus).

What causes ADHD? ADHD is a developmental impairment of the brain's executive functions.

Research to date suggests the underlying reasons for concentration and focus struggles may stem from specific cognitive weaknesses – those brain functions responsible for how well we pay attention, learn, read and remember.

Here's a great example of one such research study, conducted by the Gibson Institute of Cognitive Research and presented at the annual convention of the American Psychological Association in



August 2017 in Washington, DC. The example was titled: *"Beyond Attention: Memory and Processing Speed Deficits Dominate Cognitive Profiles in ADHD Across the Lifespan"*.

Here are some of the interesting findings:

- Attention wasn't the weakest cognitive skill among more than 5 000 children and adults formally diagnosed with ADHD.
- Across the lifespan, the greatest cognitive deficits in clients with ADHD were working memory, long-term memory and processing speed.
- Sustained attention was the fourth-weakest out of seven skills.

Does one outgrow ADHD? ADHD usually persists into adulthood.

It was once believed that children with ADHD outgrew the disorder during adolescence because hyperactivity is often reduced as children become teenagers.

While it's true that hyperactivity is usually less of an issue in teenagers and adults with ADHD, other symptoms can often get worse. These include impulsive behaviour, poor concentration and risk-taking.

Most people diagnosed with ADHD as adults recall having similar problems as children.

Are there strategies that parents can implement at home to help a child struggling with

ADHD or attention issues?

- Create structure by means of a routine and stick to it as much as possible.
- Break tasks down into manageable pieces.
- Simplify and organise your child's life.
- Limit distractions, when possible.
- Encourage exercise and outside play.
- Regulate sleep patterns – eg stick to bedtimes, getting enough sleep and not allowing the child to watch screens for an hour before bedtime.
- Encourage out-loud thinking (planning and organisational skills).



"Research to date suggests the underlying reasons for concentration and focus struggles may stem from specific cognitive weaknesses."





Ceramic painting at Clay Café in Cape Town

Founded in 1999 in the Hout Bay Valley, this popular ceramic-painting venue, restaurant and playground is a favourite among both adults and kids seeking a splash of creativity. It has outside tables in its beautiful, peaceful environment, as well as a veggie garden and its own African chic boutique. Open seven days a week, [The Clay Café](#) is an ideal day out for a one-of-a-kind creative experience.

Cycle Park at Big Red Barn

[The Big Red Barn Farm](#) in Irene, Halfway House, offers a large variety of family-fun activities and excursions, including a cycle park with fun outdoor cycling tracks and running trails – perfect for an active family outing.

Go hiking at Giba Gorge

Hidden in the Giba Valley alongside the N3 freeway, just outside Pinetown, lies the [Giba Gorge Adventure Park](#) where you'll find a haven for outdoor enthusiasts of all ages and abilities. Whether it's the kids scooting around the BMX track, avid mountain-bikers and runners making use of the single-track trails, adrenaline-fuelled downhillers or families and couples choosing to picnic on the lawn or relax at the outdoor restaurant, there's something for everyone.



Pinboard

Fun local events and outdoor activities in your city and nearby places for the whole family



Oude Molen Eco Village in Pinelands

Kids will be in their element exploring the beautiful food gardens and nurseries, stocking up on art supplies in the craft stores, playing in the swimming pool and play area, riding horses and enjoying a tasty bite at some of the small eateries dotted around [Oude Molen Eco Village](#).



Attend a cooking class at The Little Cooks Club

[The Little Cooks Club](#) was established in April 2006 in Johannesburg by qualified chef, Christine Phillips. If you and your kids are foodies or simply want to learn more about cooking, why not sign up for a family cooking class? The Little Cooks Club has franchises throughout the city and offers morning classes for kids during school holidays.

Creating the perfect homeschooling set-up

A home learning space will be the haven where your children establish, grow and expand their love of learning. Whether it's a desk in your child's room, the kitchen table or an entire room allocated to schooling, a few key aspects will set you up for success

Creating structure and order in a home learning environment can be challenging. Additionally, the curriculum can require different moving objects or furniture and having more than one child can further complicate the matter. With a proper plan, you can create a suitable environment for kids to do their schoolwork and have fun.

Here are some tips for creating your homeschooling space and making it comfortable and productive:

1 Define the workspace
If you have a large home, you can dedicate an entire room to homeschooling, but in a small house or apartment, the space can be a simple desk in the dining room or kitchen. Remember, your children need a space where they can work on projects, spread out paperwork or work alongside each other, if necessary.

2 Adequate lighting
Try to provide as much natural light as possible, but overhead or task lighting is good



too. Just ensure that your children don't have to strain to see their work.

3 Comfortable seating
While learning from a couch or a bed can be fun every now and again, it can distract children from the task at hand. Help them associate their

space with their seats by providing a chair with good support and height to work comfortably.

4 Postural reminders
You can also invest in postural reminders for older kids to prompt them to check their posture while working and correct it, if necessary. Also, encourage the kids to leave their seats regularly (recess) and stretch, walk or play.

5 Incorporate technology
Let's face it, technology plays a considerable role in your life and can be invaluable in homeschooling. It enables you



to be more productive, efficient and communicate more easily with others, so it's essential to incorporate the necessary hard- and software into your homeschooling environment.

6 Consider aesthetics
The aesthetics of your homeschooling space are essential, as visual stimuli encourage children to learn. Large, brightly coloured letters and numbers are great for little kids learning to read and count. Equally, maps, pictures, poems or inspirational quotes can engage older kids.

7 Eliminate distractions
Kids are naturally curious and some like to procrastinate. Make the space as distraction-free as possible. That might include covering the TV set, switching off cellphones and ensuring that other siblings don't make a noise within earshot. Think of different ways of adapting that will work for you. Headphones? Quiet hours?

8 Organisation
A constantly cluttered area can, in turn, clutter the mind. If your home learning space is organised, your children will know exactly where to find things and can put them away. It also gives you and your children more time to spend learning and less time having to search for what you need.



Simplify cleaning up

Make cleaning easy by placing a trash container and recycling bin near the homeschooling space. Young children (and older ones) often leave their work areas in a mess. Teach them how to clean up after themselves; it's something they'll need throughout their lives.



PLEASE, DO NOT DISTURB

10

Take it outside

On fine days, utilise your porch, patio, gazebo or garden table for homeschooling. Similar principles apply to outdoor spaces, including the use of comfortable furniture, flat working surfaces and shelter from the bright sun. You can use a carton or basket to carry things to and from the house.

Keep an open mind: your homeschool set-up doesn't have to look like a classroom. Though you require a flat surface, comfy seats and good lighting, there are workarounds for just about anything. In fact, you might be able to let your child occupy the learning space and work while you do other tasks.

SHARE YOUR HOMESCHOOL SPACE WITH US!

What makes your homeschool space special? Send your photos for us to share on our Facebook page. E-mail to: adri@isikhova.co.za

Ask Dalena



Dalena van der Westhuizen will answer any questions or concerns you may have about learning, concentration, memory and cognitive development – and, of course, the frustrations arising from these

My 15-year-old son becomes distracted extremely easily. How can I improve his focus? – *Nicola, Cape Town*

Kids who are easily distracted are usually impacted by auditory stimuli (noises, sounds) or visual stimuli (things they see) or, in some instances, both. Here are some practical tips to try:

- The teenage years and lack of sleep usually go hand in hand. I recently read an article about new research into the effect of constant sleep deprivation on the teenage brain. Lack of sleep obviously affects any person's ability to pay attention and stay focused. An interesting conclusion from this study was that teenagers actually need more sleep than younger children, so make sure your son's getting enough sleep every night.
- Make sure his workspace is set up for minimal distractions.



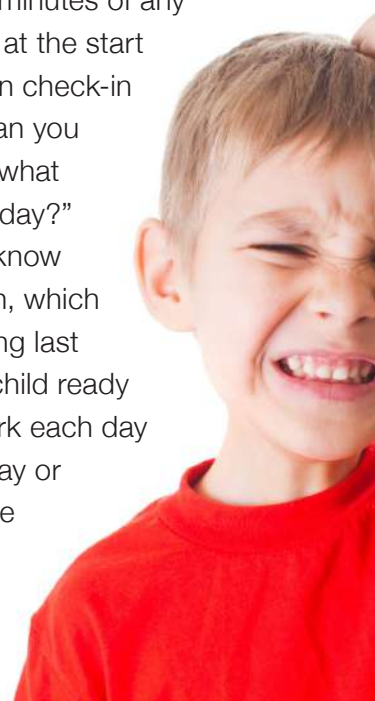
- Break down any academic work/tasks/homework into smaller chunks. It's easier to stay focused for shorter periods, so the goal here is to work intensively and remain focused for brief periods between breaks.
- Be sure to read "Top Study Tips for 2022" in issue 7 of *SAH*, which is packed with great research-based guidelines that will go a long way towards helping your son.

Before we even start doing schoolwork, I'm exhausted just from getting my two kids motivated and excited to start.

Do you have any tips for self-motivation? – Chelsey, Pretoria

To continue learning and improving, kids need intrinsic motivation. Implementing a few self-motivating strategies should make a real difference.

Explain to the kids what self-motivation is (keep it age-related) and ask each of them to come up with one strategy/plan to get them going in the morning that would make starting schoolwork easier and more fun. It has to be something practical and they must be able to stick to it for an agreed time-frame. For example: the kids could do 30 minutes of any activities they like at the start of the day, or a fun check-in such as: "What can you remember about what we studied yesterday?" or "What do you know about germination, which we were discussing last week?" The first child ready to start schoolwork each day could get extra play or device time. These





are simply suggestions which you can modify to suit your particular children and routine.

My 12-year-old son works hard and does well, but gets frustrated really easily and often gives up completely when he can't solve a problem immediately. How can I encourage him to persevere? - Kim, Johannesburg

When it comes to problem-solving, some kids need more time to work through the information. They may also have difficulty finding a logical starting point in the problem-solving process.

Of course, your son's confidence in his ability to problem-solve also plays a role.

Tackling a specific task or problem often seems like an

impossible mountain to climb. Break it down into smaller units/ tasks and let your son verbalise the problem to be solved, as well as the steps needed to be taken – he can write these down, doodle or draw them, or say them aloud. Encourage him to identify different approaches to solving the problem. Then praise his effort, no matter what the outcome might be.

My child's marks are good, but not great, especially considering how much time he spends studying. How can I tell whether his studying strategy or technique isn't really working and whether there's a different method that might work better for him? - Marlene, Louis Trichardt

It might be worth your while investigating different study strategies and techniques until your son finds one, or a combination of

About Dalena

Dalena van der Westhuizen is the co-founder and MD of BrainAbility, a cognitive development specialist, a master brain coach and an internationally certified cognitive coach. She translates the latest international cognitive research and best practice into strategies that can be applied by parents and educators alike.

A mom and a self-confessed chocoholic, Dalena enjoys working with both kids and adults to improve the way their brains process information for better learning, reading and focusing.



Send your questions for Dalena to: adri@isikhova.co.za.

techniques, that works well for him. Try incorporating some of the study tips in the article "Top Study Tips for 2022" in issue 7 of SAH magazine. However, if he then still spends a lot of time studying and his results don't improve, it might be time to consider having him assessed and then strengthening the underlying cognitive skills he relies on for easy and efficient learning.



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EDUCATION IS AN ADVENTURE

Dalena will answer any type of questions, concerns or issues you may have about learning, concentration, memory, cognitive development and of course, frustrations and problems you may have with these.

PARENTS, E-MAIL YOUR QUESTIONS TO
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ASK DALENA



A science centre is an educational facility that uses effective methods to teach science, technology, mathematics and engineering. These methods rely mainly on the use of interactive displays, events and activities, but science centres also use new technologies, such as social media, web-based education programmes and remote teaching and learning techniques.

A science centre is exactly what the word describes: a hub of science which aims to enrich the school curriculum and equip students by providing valuable hands-on learning experiences using world-class exhibits which are designed to increase students' skill and understanding of science, technology and maths. This demystifies the world of science and technology.

Science centres stimulate curiosity, develop enquiring minds and expose children and adults to positive new experiences. They help people cope with the rapidly changing technological environment and empower them by improving their life skills. They also complement the school curriculum and train science multipliers such as teachers, teacher-trainers and parents.



With more than 250 interactive science exhibits and mind-boggling puzzles, the Cape Town Science Centre (CTSC) is a world of discovery under one roof. In addition to hands-on displays and experiments, curriculum-based workshops, a science theatre and travelling exhibitions, it offers a programme specifically for homeschoolers

Explore. Create. Inspire.

They're a place for families to play around with science and help inspire individual self-guided learning. Science centres offer an environment which can showcase research and be a dynamic place for experience-sharing.

The CTSC aims to make a hands-on contribution to Africa's future by strengthening its science and technology culture through interactive methods of teaching: to excite the youth and general public about science and technology and offer educational services to students and educators across Africa.

It's partnered with countless organisations, educational NGOs, provincial and national government departments and international organisations, highlighting the importance of the centre as a platform for the delivery of science and technology learning, as well as collaboration for the greater good.

The CTSC is a member of the Southern African Association of Science & Technology Centres and a member of Cape Town Tourism.

It also offers Science Out Loud, which are popular science talks, maths and science exam preparation lessons, educator enrichment workshops and educator forums, computer courses and mini-exhibitions on topical science events.

It has a special programme for homeschool students, through which it's committed to supporting the homeschooling community with hands-on, curriculum-based

workshops. Science is a practical subject and whichever curriculum you use, carrying out experiments is a necessary part of the learning experience. The CTSC is aware of the difficulties homeschoolers have in accessing the necessary equipment in order to carry

out experiments, especially

at high school level,

which is why it offers bespoke hands-on workshops and activities for homeschooled students to assist with such practical experiments.

Parents or students who'd like to book a homeschool visit where workshops and experiments can be conducted can select the applicable education programme. For a homeschool visit, a group of 10 students or more on a similar academic level is required, so take your friends with on your excursion.

The CTSC is open Mondays-Saturdays from 09h00-16h30.



Entry fees are greatly subsidised and only one-third of actual costs are covered by entry fees. Youth (aged three to 18) and adult entry fees are R80 per person, while a family package for four people is R280. For a group of 10 or more, the entry fee is R70 per person.

“It offers bespoke hands-on workshops and activities for homeschooled students to assist with such practical experiments.”



A mother's journey through autism

There was a time when mother of three Cherese Botha couldn't even say the word "autism" out loud – it was simply too painful and devastating to utter, especially as she spent most of the year prior to his diagnosis by his side in hospital as he fought acute lymphoblastic leukaemia

"I'm really incredibly proud of Leo. I'm proud of all of us, of the progress we've made and how we've grown as individuals and as a family."

Leo was a healthy baby who was on track with all his development milestones. He was an extremely happy child who was always smiling and had just started walking.

Then he started getting sick – *really* sick. None of the antibiotics or other medicines that were prescribed for him made a difference. He was only 15 months old when Cherese's house doctor called her to say that he had received Leo's bloodwork and needed to see her immediately. Never in a million years did she imagine how her family's life would change after that visit.

Leo had acute lymphoblastic leukaemia and was rushed to Unitas Hospital in Pretoria – a 400km journey from where she and her husband Jaydee lived with Leo and their other son, Alexander, in Louis Trichardt. When they arrived at the hospital, the nurses were waiting for them. Leo received three blood transfusions that first day.

He spent most of the next few months in hospital. It was an extremely challenging time for the family, as Cherese was in Pretoria with Leo and Jaydee in Louis Trichardt with Alexander, who was only five years old at the time.

Less than six months into his chemotherapy treatment, Leo started having seizures and episodes when he stopped

breathing completely. He was sent for an MRI scan, which showed that he had developed neurotoxicity around his brain.

It was 12 months later in a neurologist's office that Cherese first heard the words "autism spectrum disorder" (ASD). Leo was three years old. The neurologist told her that he had been born with the condition. He had to start taking Risperdal and other medications for his



ASD, but after almost a year, Cherese had no choice but to stop the Risperdal. One of its side-effects is constipation, which is also a severe side-effect of chemotherapy, and it caused Leo tremendous pain.

As he began entering remission, he only needed to have chemotherapy once a month, which meant more time for him and Cherese to spend at home with Jaydee and Alexander. However, because of his weakened immune system,

Cherese decided to stay home with him full-time. He started seeing an occupational therapist, who gave Cherese activities to do with him at home. His speaking ability was unfortunately limited, but as Cherese and he worked hard at it, it slowly improved. It was also during this time that the family welcomed a new baby brother, Markus.

For financial reasons, it eventually became necessary for Cherese to return to work. She did her research thoroughly and found the perfect nursery school that Leo could attend in the mornings. He loved school and thrived there.

Then came Covid-19.

Leo's occupational therapist still gave Cherese activities to do with him at home while schools were closed. She also asked several kindergarten teachers in her area for worksheets.

Schoolwork is something Leo's always enjoyed tremendously. Although his academic ability is about two years behind that of his peers, it's never bothered him. He simply continues on his own, is very patient and always does his best. For him and Cherese, there's no rush to learn – and if some things take a little longer than they would take others, such as pencil-gripping due to his low muscle tone, it doesn't bother them. They both know he'll master it in his own time.

When schools reopened, Leo was extremely excited to return – but another obstacle arose. The Department of Education objected to a child aged seven still being in kindergarten with toddlers. Although his special needs and academic ability were explained to the department, it insisted that the Bothas find an alternative option.

As *SAH* interviewed Cherese, she was watching Leo as he sat near us at the table colouring in, which he does particularly well and neatly. She's also very proud that he recently mastered cutting out with scissors. They celebrate every milestone.

She says it sometimes feels surreal thinking what Leo's been through and she realises that the road ahead will still be full of many challenges, especially since he was also diagnosed with Hirschsprung's disease

(missing nerve cells in the muscles of part or all of the colon, making it difficult to pass stools) earlier this year.

Cherese sometimes thinks back to the relaxed, happy-go-lucky wife and mother she once was and how the past six years have changed her. Today, she's over-protective, not only of Leo, but of all three of her boys.

"I'm really incredibly proud of Leo. I'm proud of all of us, of the progress we've made and how we've grown as individuals and as a family," she says.



DID YOU KNOW?



The term "autism" was changed to "autism spectrum disorder" ("ASD") in 2013 by the American Psychiatric Association. ASD is now an umbrella term that covers autistic disorder, pervasive developmental disorder and Asperger's syndrome.

How well someone with ASD can function in day-to-day life depends on the severity of their symptoms. Given that autism varies widely in everyday impairment, the symptoms of some people aren't always easily recognised.

While ASD is believed to be a disorder of very early brain development, the behavioural signs of autism characteristics surface between the ages of 18 months and three years.

Based on the most recent Centres for Disease Control and Prevention report, ASD is estimated to affect about one in 54 children, with boys being more likely to have it than girls.



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Easter crafts and learning fun!

Looking for ways to keep the kids entertained over Easter? These homemade projects will ensure young minds stay happy and focused

Easter's around the corner and now's a great time to help your child express their creative side with these easy and affordable Easter crafts.

May get to have a while they out perhaps want to, plenty to adult ty too!"

Depending on your child's age, you may get the chance to have a cup of tea while they decorate... but perhaps you won't want to, as there's plenty to inspire adult creativity too!

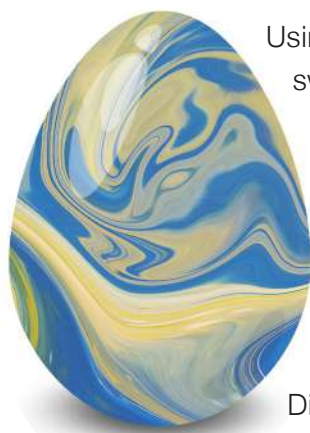
There are plenty of inventive and exciting activities both you and your kids can do. Here are our favourites:

Easter egg marbling

The art of marbling is the perfect stay-at-home Easter activity.

What do you need?

- Eggs
- Paper or card
- A deep bowl or tray
- A cocktail stick
- Marbling inks or nail polish (newer ones work best)
- Kitchen roll
- Egg shells (insides removed and washed)



How to do it

Start by brushing your shells with acrylic paint, if you want to cover their original colour.

Fill a deep bowl with water and add a few drops of nail varnish or marbling ink into the centre (this is a step for adults).

Using the cocktail stick, swirl the ink around in the bowl to create your required pattern (parents might want to do this step and the next one themselves or supervise older children).

Dip the egg straight into the water with the cocktail stick and pull it out.

It dries immediately, so you can double-dip to create a layered effect.

Bunny and chick sweetie jars

Make these chocolate-filled jars



with your children to give to their friends or teachers – or hide them for an Easter treat hunt in the garden.

What do you need?

- A glass jar with screw lid
- Craft paint suitable for glass
- Sharpie pens
- A patterned card
- Glue
- Pom-poms (chick only)
- Chocolate eggs and chocolate coins

How to do it

Paint the lids and jars, leaving a circle at the front of the jar unpainted. Allow them to dry thoroughly before applying a second coat.

Once they're dry, draw faces on your bunny or chick with Sharpie pens.

Cut out bunny ears or chick party hats from the patterned card. Glue pom-poms to the party hats. Bend back a 1cm-wide flap of card at the base of each ear or party hat and glue them to the jar lids.

To finish, fill the jars with chocolates.

Carrot collage

Help your child create a snack for the Easter Bunny with this fun and easy carrot collage.

What do you need?

Orange and white construction paper or cardstock

Green crayons

Scissors

Child-safe glue

How to do it

Have your child tear up pieces of the orange paper – or, if they're old enough, they can cut small pieces with safety scissors (it's best if the pieces are on the larger side, so that attaching them is easier).

Meanwhile, cut the white construction paper or card-stock into a large wedge shape and apply glue to one side.

Let your child place the pieces of



Fun Times!

orange paper all over the glued carrot shape.

Once the glue has dried, cut the remaining white paper into smaller triangles to represent the stem of the carrot and glue or staple this paper to the carrot.

Have your child colour this stem with the green crayons.

Toilet roll bunnies

The clue really is in the name. Cheap, simple fun – what more could you want!?

What do you need?

A cardboard toilet roll centre

Scissors

Glue

Paintbrushes

Paint

How to do it

Cut the cardboard toilet roll centre into three equal pieces.

Keep one as a circle shape and squash the other two down flat so that they form the bunny ear shape.

Using glue, fix the two ear shapes to the top of the circle.

Leave them to dry and then dip into some paint for bunny face printing.

Tissue paper Easter egg

These eggs are perfect for displaying in the window, letting the sun illuminate the bright Easter colours of the tissue paper.

What do you need?

Black or white construction paper

Coloured tissue paper

A glue stick

Safety scissors

How to do it

Fold a sheet of construction paper in half and draw half of an oval. About 2,5cm inside this, draw another line in the same shape.

Cut along both lines and unfold the paper. This will give you an egg-shaped border.

Help your child tear or cut large strips of the tissue paper and glue them together, attaching the edges to the border of the egg.

Ensure the tissue paper overlaps so that no gaps are visible.

Cape Town teen starts glass recycling project

Sixteen-year-old Jordan Prince has always been passionate about helping the environment. With his latest recycling initiative #heart4glass, he hopes to get the whole of Camps Bay involved in and excited about glass recycling

“I’ve always been passionate about our planet, the ecosystem, science and life in general,” Jordan tells SAH. Recycling has been part of his daily life ever since he can remember and he’s been recycling plastics, cardboard paper, cans, old batteries and CDs at school and at home since Grade 1.

In 2021 Jordan introduced the #heart4glass project to Camps Bay High School and encouraged the pupils and the entire community to place their glass bottles, containers and other glass wastage in it for recycling, rather than throw them away. More than a year later the project’s still going strong.

“I always try to be true to myself and the values I believe in,” says Jordan, “and I do my best to set a good example for others.” During



the Covid-19 lockdown, Jordan and his family were involved in community clean-ups that were spearheaded by his mother, Natasha, and himself. He also recently started educating youth, friends and family members in his neighbourhood about the importance of recycling. In addition, he’s part of the President’s Awards campaign.

“I believe in giving back and empowering others through initiatives like recycling and getting involved in other charitable causes. I’m very



passionate about my community and believe that together, we can achieve a lot,” says Jordan.

“Everyone should do their part in making the world a better place. All communities can participate or initiate activities or projects to help reduce waste. Each of us can make a difference by re-using and recycling, and by encouraging our neighbours to do the same.”

MAKE THE
Difference

“Each of us can make a difference by re-using and recycling, and by encouraging our neighbours to do the same.”





The unique joys (and challenges) of parenting teenage twins

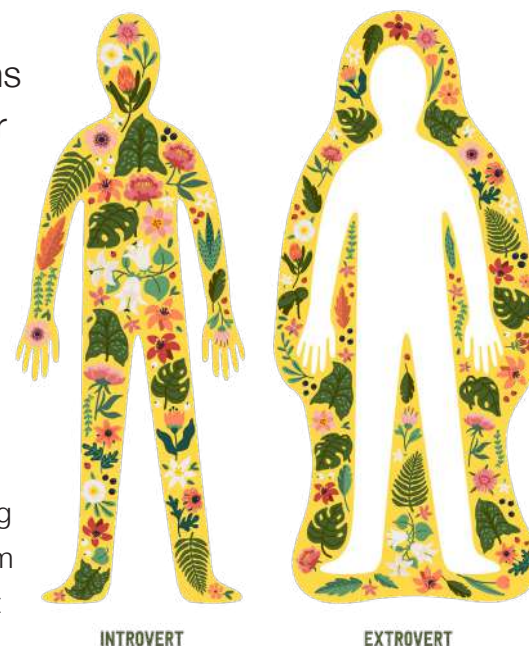
There's no denying that growing up as a twin is pretty special. However, for a parent, twins can often be the focus of comparisons and competitiveness. Laurine Venter tells *SAH* about parenting her twin teenage girls, Geraldine and Nicoline

In what ways are Geraldine and Nicoline similar and different?

They're non-identical 16-year-old twins. They were born on 17 December 2005, six weeks prematurely. Geraldine was ready to come out, but Nicoline's lungs weren't fully developed yet, so they had to take her to the ICU. They didn't want to separate the babies, so they

took Geraldine to be at Nicoline's side. A week later, on 24 December, my husband Maarten and I took both our baby daughters home.

The two of them differ like day and night. While they both have very strong personalities, which often causes them to lock horns, Geraldine's an extrovert



– like her father – who loves people and being busy. Nicoline has more of my personality. She's introverted and shy, unless she's in the company of people with whom she feels comfortable.

Nicoline was born with a birthmark under her eyebrow, which in her younger years may have contributed to her being more withdrawn. However, Geraldine took her under her wing and always looked out for her. When Nicoline was little, she underwent surgery to lighten the birthmark. The doctors said they could do another procedure when she turned 16, but she says she doesn't want it removed because it's part of what makes her unique.

As for similarities, both the girls are very determined and committed, no matter what they tackle. Both are doing well academically and are also very good tennis- and hockey-players. Sometimes one has to work a little harder than the other,



but the girls are good motivation for each other. They also have the same values.

A relationship between twins is always very close. How does this affect their other relationships with, for example, you, their father or their younger brother [also called Maarten]?

The girls are without a doubt each other's best friends and greatest confidantes. Although they have separate rooms, they shared a bed until last year. They call each other "sussie". Even though we're a very close family, their relationship is extra-special and we accept it that way. I know they tell each other everything before they tell me!

When it comes to schoolwork, do they have different weaknesses and strengths? Do their subjects differ? They both generally do well in most subjects. Yet this year, for the first time, they took different subjects. Geraldine



has geography as a subject and Nicoline tourism.

Are they academically competitive? Definitely! They both have very competitive natures, Geraldine perhaps more so than Nicoline. But they motivate each other to do better.

Do they have different interests outside of academia? Are they interested in the same sports and are they also competitive with others? They're both competitive in hockey and tennis. While Geraldine sometimes has the upper hand in hockey, Nicoline's recently had the upper hand in tennis.

"My daughters have taught me a lot about unconditional love, because despite the competitive world in which we live, they really do love each other unconditionally."



What advice can you offer other mothers of teenage twins?

Never compare them with each other or make them feel as if they're living in each other's shadow. Give each one their own space and make sure they make their own choices – what one wants to do isn't necessarily what the other one wants. That's why we gave each of our girls her own room, which reflects who she is as an individual and where she can go if she wants to be alone.

Grant them and encourage their own identities.

In primary school, we decided to separate the girls in Grades 1, 2 and 3 so that they could each have their own story to tell about what happened in class when they got home.

What also made things easy for us from their birth was routine. To this day, it's what works for us at home.

It's sometimes challenging being the mother of twins and can feel as if you need to split yourself, but you learn and grow with them. My daughters have taught me a lot about unconditional love, because despite the competitive world in which we live, they really do love each other unconditionally.



Has there ever been an occasion when one achieved something for which both worked hard? If so, how have you handled it? There have been many occasions when one girl was chosen for the A team and the other one for the B team, or when one sister was named one of the top performers and the other sister not.

There have been many occasions when I've been happy for one, but also disappointed for the other. There have been many tears. Fortunately, they're very supportive of each other, which makes it much easier.

There's never jealousy. I usually talk to the one who's disappointed and just say that no two people are the same, that we all have our own strengths and that this should be her motivation to work even harder. The girls are always excited or sad for each other when something happens. They really are each other's biggest fans and support.

Do they do homework or work on assignments together? No, never. Their study methods, like their natures, are totally different. Nicoline needs complete silence when she works or studies. Geraldine says everything aloud to herself when she does her homework or studies, so they always do their schoolwork in separate rooms. With projects, they sometimes ask each other about things they don't understand, but they never do the work together.

What are their ambitions? Geraldine wants to become a lawyer and Nicoline a teacher.



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Metals and Non-metals

Complete each block by filling in a characteristic of a metal:

These characteristics are the reason why metals are so useful to make a variety of things.

Complete the following table:

Type of metal	Description	Used to make:
Iron		
	Red in colour. Conducts electricity very well.	
		Window frames, cans, tins, foil.
Gold		
	Very shiny.	
	Soft metal that is malleable. Dull grey colour.	



Did you know, there are around 4 times more metals than non -metals on Earth. And everything on Earth is made by metals and non-metals.

Carbon is one of the most common forms of non-metals. Can you identify the following uses of carbon?





Do you know what happened to the chain in this picture?

The chain is made from iron and it got exposed to air and water.

The iron starts to **rust**. The rust starts to eat the metal and soon holes appear in the iron. If the process is not stopped, the object can disintegrate.

There are a few ways in which we can stop iron from rusting. Do some research and find out what we can do:



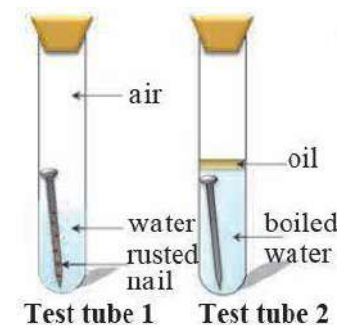
Let's see how rust is formed, given the presence of water and air.

You will need:

- 2x glass containers
- 2x nails
- plain water
- boiled water
- oil

Steps:

1. Put plain water in one glass. Submerge a nail into the water.
2. Put boiled water in the other glass, followed by another nail. Top the glass off with a tiny layer of oil.
3. Observe both objects for 7 days.



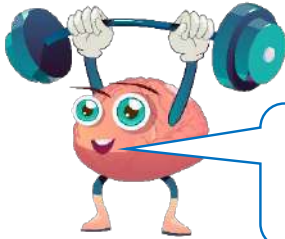
1. Why do you use plain water in one glass and boiling water in the other glass?

--

2. Why do you put a layer of oil over the boiled water?

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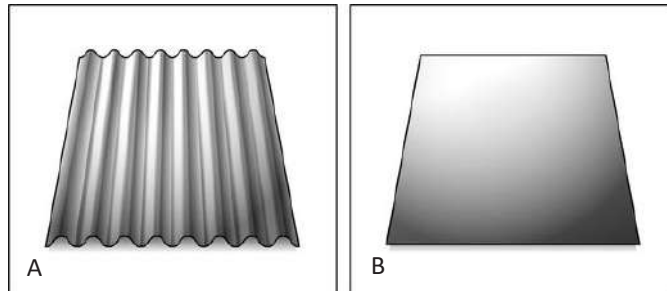
3. Compare what happened to the nails in the experiment.



Strengthening objects

Did you know that we can strengthen materials? Think of a material like paper. On its own it's not that strong. It can bend and tear easily. But we can use different techniques to strengthen it.

Strengthen by folding.

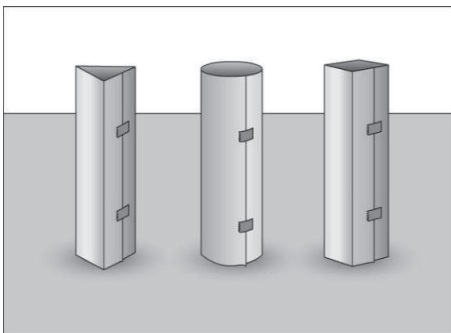


1. You will fold one sheet of paper (A), while keeping another sheet as is (B).
2. Gently try to bend sheet A and sheet B.
3. How do the two sheets differ?

-
4. Which sheet is easier to bend?

-
5. Does folding make a material stronger?

Strengthen with hollow pillars.



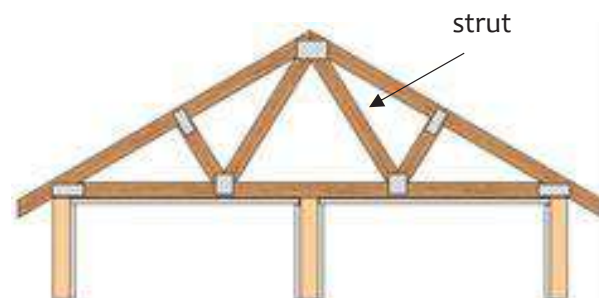
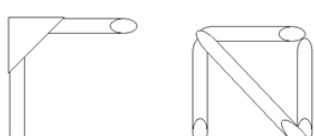
We can also strengthen paper by folding it into triangular, circular and square pillars.

Test it at home:

Fold paper into these three pillars. Put a book on top of your pillar and see which shaped pillar will hold the most weight.

Strengthen with struts.

Struts provide stability to a structure and makes sure that the frame does not move. Struts must be made of strong materials.



Answer sheets

Metals and Non-metals

Complete each block by filling in a characteristic of a metal:

shiny

hard

strong

malleable

flexible

These characteristics are the reason why metals are so useful to make a variety of things.

Complete the following table:

Type of metal	Description	Used to make:
Iron	Dark grey, affordable and strong. Rusts when in contact with water and air.	Nails, screws, fencing, etc.
Copper	Red in colour. Conducts electricity very well.	Waterpipes, electrical wires
Aluminum	Light weight. Silver/grey. Very malleable and flexible	Window frames, cans, tins, foil.
Gold	Bright yellow colour and shiny. Malleable and flexible.	Jewelry, coins
Silver	Very shiny.	Jewelry, coins, mirrors, etc.
Lead	Soft metal that is malleable. Dull grey colour.	Sinkers, weight-belts for scuba divers



Did you know, there are around 4 times more metals than non-metals on Earth. And everything on Earth is made by metals and non-metals.

Carbon is one of the most common forms of non-metals. Can you identify the following uses of carbon?



Coal



Charcoal



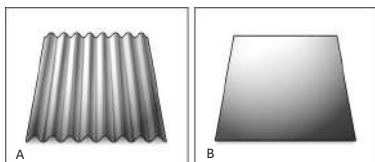
uncut diamonds



Strengthening objects

Did you know that we can strengthen materials? Think of a material like paper. On its own it's not that strong. It can bend and tear easily. But we can use different techniques to strengthen it.

Strengthen by folding.



- You will fold one sheet of paper (A), while keeping another sheet as is (B).
- Gently try to bend sheet A and sheet B.
- How do the two sheets differ?

Sheet A is stronger and doesn't bend as easily as sheet B.

- Which sheet is easier to bend?

Sheet B

- Does folding make a material stronger?

Yes, it does.



Do you know what happened to the chain in this picture?

The chain is made from iron and it got exposed to air and water.

The iron starts to **rust**. The rust starts to eat the metal and soon holes appear in the iron. If the process is not stopped, the object can disintegrate.

There are a few ways in which we can stop iron from rusting. Do some research and find out what we can do:

- Cover it with grease or oil.
- Cover it with paint, like painting bridges.
- Cover it with plastic, like with fencing wire.
- Cover it with sink, like corrugated iron sheets.
- Cover it with chrome.



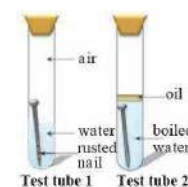
Let's see how rust is formed, given the presence of water and air.

You will need:

- 2x glass containers
- 2x nails
- plain water
- boiled water
- oil

Steps:

- Put plain water in one glass. Submerge a nail into the water.
- Put boiled water in the other glass, followed by another nail. Top the glass off with a tiny layer of oil.
- Observe both objects for 7 days.



- Why do you use plain water in one glass and boiling water in the other glass?

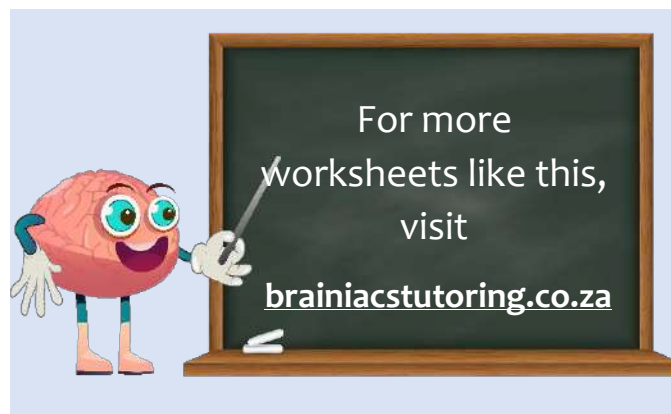
Plain water has air present. When you boil it, it removes oxygen molecules from the water.

- Why do you put a layer of oil over the boiled water?

To ensure no air reaches the boiled water.

- Compare what happened to the nails in the experiment.

The nail with plain water and exposure to air will rust quickly. The other nail will either not rust at all or very little, depending on how much air it got exposed to.



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